

100 Days of Linux - Day 083

Title: Exporting Environment Variables

Today's Goal

Learn how to export shell variables so they are available to child processes and applications.

Why This Matters

Exported variables are widely used to configure development tools, cloud SDKs, databases and automation scripts.

Commands of the Day

Syntax:

```
export NAME=Vishal
printenv NAME
echo $NAME
```

Examples:

```
export PROJECT=linux
printenv PROJECT
```

Beginner Lesson

A normal shell variable is available only in the current shell. Using **export** makes it available to programs started from that shell. You can verify exported variables with **printenv**.

Practice Questions

1. Export a variable named COURSE with the value Linux.
2. Display COURSE using echo.
3. Display COURSE using printenv.
4. Export a variable named PROJECT with any value.
5. List all exported variables using printenv.

Hints

Use **export VARIABLE=value**. Verify with **printenv VARIABLE**.

Mini Challenge

Export three variables named NAME, CITY and SKILL, then display all three using echo.

Common Mistakes

Forgetting the export keyword, adding spaces around '=', or expecting non-exported variables to appear in printenv.

Did You Know?

Many command-line tools read exported environment variables automatically when they start.

Pro Tip

Use uppercase names for environment variables to distinguish them from regular shell variables.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

- Q1: export COURSE=Linux
Q2: echo \$COURSE
Q3: printenv COURSE
Q4: export PROJECT=myproject
Q5: printenv

Homework

Create and export five environment variables, then verify each one with printenv.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll learn how to make environment variables permanent using shell configuration files.